Paradzai Gwira

AI Software Engineer · Formally Trained Autodidact

Generative AI · Distributed Systems · Telecom & Real-time Data

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Open to relocation and remote roles

PROFILE

Formally trained autodidact and AI Software Engineer with 5+ years of turning research into production systems across generative AI, telecommunications, fintech, loyalty and real-time data. Currently architecting LLM, RAG and AI-agent solutions for enterprise and telecom use cases. Previously led VoIP product engineering and built an open-source, change-data-capture data warehouse powering revenue assurance for a telecom operator. A university foundation in algorithms, discrete mathematics and system design, extended by teaching myself every modern stack I use, from SIP and 5G cores to Spring Boot and agentic AI. I do my best work in lab-style teams where ideas are prototyped, measured and shipped.

5+	9+	5+	12
years in production engineering	apps live in public app stores	domains: AI, telecom, fintech, loyalty, data	payment & operator integrations delivered

Apps in public stores: Taura · Points Africa · Kurira · Mobilielink · CatchApp · Maswerasei · Homekonnect · Umbai Merchant · Hello Africa (Android · iOS · Huawei AppGallery · Web (PWA))

CORE SKILLS

AI & Machine Learning	Generative AI · LLMs · RAG · AI agents · Prompt engineering · Model evaluation · Responsible AI · Python
Backend & Distributed Systems	Java · Spring Boot · Spring Cloud · Node.js · TypeScript · Go · C# / .NET · REST · gRPC · GraphQL · Microservices · RabbitMQ
Data & Streaming	Debezium CDC · Redpanda / Kafka · ClickHouse · Data warehousing · Grafana · SQL
Telecom & Networks	SIP / VoIP · OpenSIPS · CGRateS · LTE 4G EPC · Open5GS 5G Core · 6G research · Operator integrations
Mobile & Platforms	Flutter / Dart · Kotlin · React Native · .NET MAUI · Android · iOS · Huawei HMS · PWA · Firebase · Codemagic · Shorebird OTA · Strapi CMS
Cloud, DevOps & Quality	Docker · Kubernetes · Helm · Ansible · GitHub Actions · GitLab CI · Jenkins · AWS · Linux · TDD · JUnit · Jest

EXPERIENCE

AI Software Engineer

Econet AI (Econet Wireless)

Jul 2026 – Present
Full-time · On-site

- Lead the architecture and technical design of enterprise AI solutions, integrating generative AI, LLM, RAG and AI-agent capabilities into telecom and business services.
- Build scalable AI and data pipelines that process, analyse and extract insight from large operational datasets.
- Develop Java / Spring Boot and Python microservices and APIs that connect AI models to core enterprise systems.
- Evaluate, optimise and productionise models for performance, reliability, scalability and cost efficiency.
- Establish AI engineering practice across teams: model evaluation, prompt engineering, monitoring, security and responsible AI.
- Research emerging models, frameworks and tools, running proofs of concept that shape the AI roadmap.

Mobile Full-Stack Developer

Points Africa

Oct 2025 – Present
Part-time · Remote

- Build and maintain a cross-platform loyalty platform for PWA, Android and iOS in Flutter / Dart.
- Design secure, scalable RESTful APIs and cloud / serverless backend services with Node.js and Express.

- Optimise performance and responsiveness across platforms; own code reviews, bug triage and technical documentation.
- Ship in Agile sprints with automated testing and CI/CD across the full software development lifecycle.

Senior Software, VoIP & Data Engineer (Technical Lead)

Oct 2021 – Jun 2026

Africom Telecommunications

Full-time · Hybrid

- Led development of VoIP mobile apps for Android, iOS and Huawei devices and their SIP back ends, including Taura: low-cost international calls to any mobile or landline, with no internet or app needed on the receiving end.
- Architected and integrated real-time billing (CGRateS), SIP routing and call processing (OpenSIPS) and chatbot platforms.
- Built an open-source, real-time data warehouse in Node.js, Go and Java: Debezium change-data-capture over a Redpanda message bus into ClickHouse.
- Designed revenue assurance dashboards and reporting that validated finance and warehouse figures and helped control revenue leakage through major core-network changes.
- Delivered backend services, APIs and secure payment gateway modules in Node.js and Java for VoIP, messaging and payment apps (Taura, Kurira, CatchApp, InterTalk and more) serving thousands of users.
- Deployed and maintained LTE 4G EPC network infrastructure; ran Linux servers, databases and DevOps pipelines.
- Mentored junior engineers through pair programming and code reviews.

Full-Stack Developer

Jun 2023 – May 2025

Umbai

Contract · Remote

- Built WhatsApp chatbots and business automations that handled customer service, sales and order workflows.
- Integrated 6 payment gateways (including PayPal and leading mobile-money wallets) and the services of 6 mobile network operators.
- Developed hybrid and mobile apps with .NET MAUI, C#, Vue.js and Angular, backed by MVC microservices and REST APIs.
- Administered Linux servers and databases; configured site-to-site VPNs and DevOps workflows.

R&D LAB & OPEN SOURCE

Real-time CDC data warehouse

`Debezium · Redpanda · ClickHouse · Grafana`

Open-source streaming warehouse keeping analytics in sync with operational databases for revenue assurance.

5G core lab & 6G exploration

`Open5GS · 5G SA · 6G`

Building 5G standalone networks on open-source Open5GS, exploring emerging 6G features and growing an open-telecom community.

flutter_dtmf_pro

`Dart · Flutter plugin · Android / iOS / Web`

Open-source plugin generating DTMF telephony tones for VoIP and communication apps.

Grounded portfolio AI assistant

`LLM · Gemini · React`

Assistant that answers only from a verified knowledge base and hands off to a human when unsure.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

BSc (Hons) Information Technology, Software Engineering

2019 – 2023

Bindura University of Science Education

Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE 21 Developer

In preparation

Languages: English (professional) · Shona (native)

Interests: Open-source contribution, mentoring early-career engineers, hackathons, research prototypes, 5G/6G networks.